Team Retrospective Document

SA Learnerships and Skills Development Portal

Sprint Team 1 Retrospective

What Went Well?

During the duration of Sprint 1, the team successfully set up the foundation of the SA Learnerships and Skills Development Portal project. Core functionalities such as Google authentication, default applicant role assignment, and opportunity creation were implemented successfully. The team also managed to organize the GitHub repository structure and establish an understanding of the project architecture. Tasks were allocated clearly among team members, and most of the planned user stories were completed before the end of the sprint.

What Did Not Go Well?

One of the challenges during Sprint 1 was that a significant amount of time was spent on setup and planning, which slowed the development progress. The team also experienced some uncertainty regarding the implementation decisions; an example of this is the approach to Google authentication, where two members used two conflicting ways to implement shared logic.

Improvements for Sprint 2

For sprint 2, the team agreed that communication should be improved further, especially when making decisions regarding shared logic/functionality. The team also agreed to track progress more consistently. The team decided to make better use of the GitHub issue tracker for bugs and task tracking to ensure that every single person tests their functionality before merging changes into shared branches.

Sprint 2 Team Retrospective

What Went Well?

During Sprint 2, the team successfully implemented important applicant-side functionality such as profile creation, profile editing, application submission and viewing submitted applications. Progress was monitored regularly through sprint meetings, and team members demonstrated their work while discussing technical issues together. The team also improved collaboration compared to Sprint 1 by helping each other debug issues and align implementation decisions. Significant progress was made on frontend and backend integration, testing, and UML diagram updates.

What Did Not Go Well?

Although good progress was made during the sprint, not all user stories were fully completed before the sprint deadline. Some features still contained bugs and integration problems, particularly around frontend and backend connectivity, deployment, and CV upload functionality. There were also delays caused by incomplete testing and unresolved performance issues in some parts of the application. In addition, some user stories needed to be rewritten because the benefit clauses were not consistent with proper user story structure.

Improvements for Sprint 3

For Sprint 3, the team agreed to focus more on completing unfinished user stories and improving overall code quality. Members also agreed to improve testing efforts and ensure better consistency between UML diagrams and implementation logic. The team planned to improve progress tracking, reduce bugs before sprint deadlines, and communicate more frequently when working on shared components or making major changes to the system.

Sprint 3 Team Retrospective

What Went Well?

Sprint 3 was one of the most productive sprints for the team. The team successfully implemented provider-side workflows such as shortlisting and rejecting applications, together with in-app notification functionality. Standardised qualifications and skill tags aligned with NQF datasets were also implemented successfully. Team members regularly demonstrated progress during meetings, and collaboration improved significantly compared to previous sprints. The team also managed to complete unfinished user stories carried over from Sprint 2 while still making progress on newly assigned functionality.

What Did Not Go Well?

Despite the strong progress made during the sprint, the team still experienced several technical and integration challenges. The project encountered branch inconsistencies, JWT conflicts between cookies and local storage, frontend issues, and difficulties integrating features across different branches. Some functionality also required redesign after implementation, particularly around improving the provider workflow for reviewing applications before shortlisting them. There were also delays related to documentation updates, UML adjustments, and frontend fixes near the sprint deadline

Improvements for Sprint 4

For Sprint 4, the team agreed to focus more on final system stability, testing and deployment preparation. Members also agreed to communicate more clearly before making changes to shared files and authentication logic. The team planned to complete all remaining functionality earlier in the sprint to allow more time for final polishing, bug fixing, deployment, and preparation for the final project submission.

Sprint 4 Retrospective

What Went Well?

During Sprint 4, the team successfully implemented advanced analytics and reporting features such as custom analytics views, application volume reports, placement success reports, and opportunity auto-matching functionality. Significant progress was also made towards final system integration, documentation completion, and final testing preparation. Team members collaborated effectively to resolve issues related to analytics pages, authentication conflicts, and report generation. The team also organised shared responsibilities for the final project submission, ensuring that deployment, testing, documentation, Scrum artefacts, and video demonstrations were distributed fairly among members to reduce workload pressure near the final deadline.

What Did Not Go Well?

Sprint 4 was challenging because it overlapped with academic commitments, which delayed progress for some members. The deployment process experienced significant delays due to Azure account limitations, authentication configuration issues, and unresolved production environment problems. The team also encountered merge conflicts, UI bugs, and integration problems while preparing the final working branch. Although backend code coverage improved significantly, the reported coverage did not fully include all newly implemented Sprint 4 functionality after branch integration. Some members also started assigned work later than expected, which created pressure close to the final submission deadline.

Lessons Learned

The team agreed that future projects should include stricter implementation timelines and earlier deployment preparation to avoid delays close to submission deadlines. More frequent integration testing and continuous code coverage checks should also be performed throughout the sprint instead of near the end. The team also recognised the importance of improving branch management, documenting architectural decisions earlier, and maintaining consistent communication when working on shared functionality to reduce integration conflicts and deployment issues.
